

THE RIGHT TO LIBERTY AND SECURITY

THE EUROPEAN CONVENTION ON HUMAN RIGHTS (1950)



IN CONTEXT

FOCUS

Human rights

BEFORE

1945 Europe is devastated after World War II. No court exists to protect human rights anywhere in the world.

1948 The UN issues the Universal Declaration of Human Rights.

AFTER

1960 The European Court of Human Rights (ECtHR) delivers its first judgment, in the case of *Lawless v. Ireland*, which involves the detention of a terrorist suspect.

1998 Protocol No. 11 compels all member countries to let individuals access the ECtHR.

2017 The ECtHR delivers its 20,000th judgment.

The European Convention on Human Rights (ECHR) is a treaty on human rights between the 47 member states of the Council of Europe—not to be confused with the entirely separate European Union (EU). The ECHR was rooted in western Europe's resolve to rebuild after World War II and to protect itself against the rise of communism in Eastern Europe.

In 1948, 750 delegates at the Congress of Europe studied ideas for uniting and legally integrating Europe. When the newly formed Council of Europe met in 1949, its focus had become more modest in scope: the creation of a human rights treaty that, by protecting